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FLIPKART MINUTES

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Minutes or Miles?

Flipkart Minutes enters India's booming quick commerce segment, taking on Blinkit, Zepto, and Swiggy Instamart. While supply chain gives it an edge, leadership uncertainty and intense competition pose challenges

BY **PALAK AGARWAL**

► **INDIA'S QUICK COMMERCE** sector has seen an explosive rise from a niche play into a \$3.5 billion market in just over four years. By 2030, the industry is projected to touch \$40 billion, as per Datum Intelligence.

At the forefront of this boom are Blinkit, Zepto, and Swiggy Instamart, each aggressively expanding their reach. But the battle is far from over. Newer entrants such as BBNOW, Amazon's Tez, and Flipkart Minutes—the latest from the Walmart-backed e-commerce giant—are also vying for a foothold in this fast-evolving landscape. This is Flipkart's third attempt at grocery delivery. While

it has built a robust foundation this time, sustaining in the high-stakes quick commerce arena remains a formidable challenge.

For now, Flipkart Minutes, launched in August 2024 in Bengaluru, has expanded to Mumbai, Delhi, Lucknow, Kolkata, and Ahmedabad, with around 160 dark stores. Sources say the company aims to scale up this network to 500 by March 2025.

"Flipkart doesn't see major supply chain challenges as it has already been operating in grocery," says a source familiar with the company's plans. But why did it fail twice earlier? Aakash Agrawal, Head, Digital & New

Age Businesses at Anand Rathi Investment Banking, says quick commerce is a matter of timing. "Food delivery took a long time to be streamlined. Many players attempted grocery delivery since 2013. These models faced several challenges, but the issues were eventually addressed."

"For Flipkart Minutes, market perception played a key role," says Rathi. Flipkart is primarily known for e-commerce, whereas companies launching separate quick commerce apps aimed to establish a distinct market positioning. Now, as Flipkart goes all in with Flipkart Minutes, it benefits from its robust supply chain